



Distributed Systems

Introduction

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Course Content



Introduction to Distributed Systems, Basic Algorithms in Message Passing System, Leader Election in Rings, Distributed Minimum Spanning Tree, Models of Distributed Computation, Causality & Logical Time, Global State and Snapshot Recording Algorithms, Distributed Mutual Exclusion Algorithms, Distributed Shared Memory, Consensus and Agreement Algorithms, Impossibility of distributed consensus with one faulty process, Fault-tolerance, PAXOS and Friends, **Distributed Data Analytics: MapReduce, Distributed Machine Learning**, Blockchain Consensus: Introduction to Blockchain Consensus, blockchain, Bitcoin blockchain consensus, The CAP Theorem, Advanced Topics: Edge Computing

Books



1. Kskhemkalyani, A. and Singhal, M. Distributed Computing: Principles, Algorithms and Systems. Cambridge University Press
2. Attiya, Hagit, and Jennifer Welch. Distributed computing: fundamentals, simulations, and advanced topics. *Vol. 19. John Wiley & Sons, 2004.*
3. Lynch, Nancy A. Distributed algorithms. *Elsevier, 1996.*
4. Coulouris G, Dollimore J, Kindberg T and Blair G, Distributed Systems: Concepts and Design, Pearson Education
5. Tanenbaum A S and Steen M V, Distributed Systems: Principles and Paradigms, Pearson Education

Background Needed



- Data Structures and Algorithms
- ✓ • Computer Networks
- ✓ • Operating Systems
 - Database management systems
 - Unix
 - C / C++
 - Socket API
 - RPC

What is a distributed system?



- A distributed system is a ^① collection of independent computers ^② that appear to the users of the system as a single computer. [Andrew Tanenbaum]
Ameoba
- A distributed system is a collection of processors that do not ^③ share memory or clock. Instead each processor has its own local memory and the processors communicate with one another through communication lines. [Galvin et al.]
^④
- System of networked computers that
 - communicate and coordinate their actions **only** by passing messages

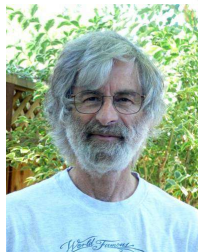
[Coulouris et al.]

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What is a distributed system?



*“A distributed system is one in which the failure of a computer **you didn't even know** existed can render your own computer unusable”*



Turing

-Leslie Lamport

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What is a distributed system?



- ✓ Concurrency *Adv.*
- ✓ No global clock *issue*
- ✓ Independent failure

[Coulouris et al.]

- A collection of mostly autonomous processors communicating over a communication network and having the following features

- ✓ No common physical clock
- ✓ No shared memory
- ✓ Geographical separation
- ✓ Autonomy and heterogeneity

[Singhal and Kskhemkalyani]

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What is a distributed system?



- A practical “distributed system” will probably have both
 - ✓ Processes on different computers that communicate by messages
 - ✓ Processes/threads on a computer that communicate by messages or shared memory

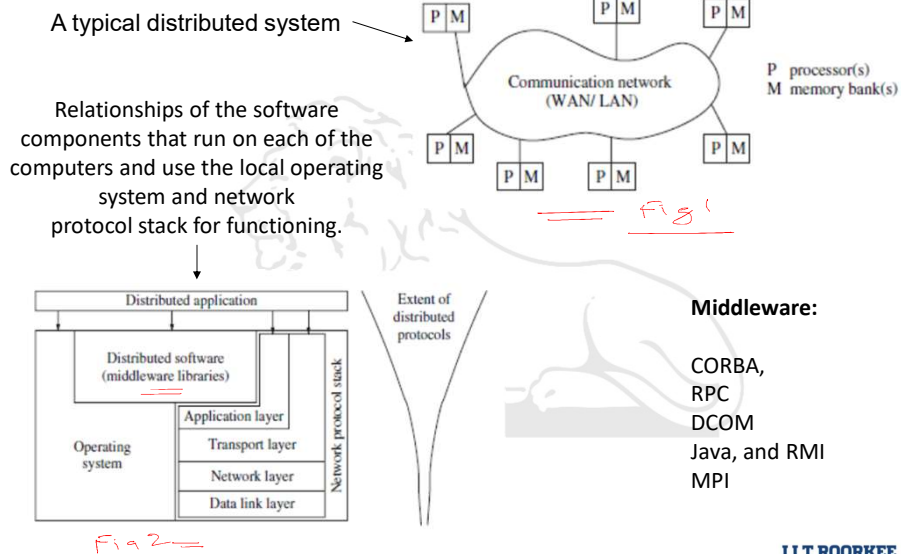
ipc *pipes*
message queues

A very broad definition:

- A set of autonomous processes communicating among themselves to perform a task
 - ✓ Autonomous: able to act independently
 - ✓ Communication: shared memory or message passing

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Distributed systems



Flynn's taxonomy

- Feng*
- Single Instruction Single Data (SISD)
 - Single Instruction Multiple Data (SIMD)
 - Multiple Instruction Single Data (MISD)
 - Multiple Instruction Multiple Data (MIMD) *←*
- Feng*
- IIT ROORKEE

Why distributed systems?



- **Nature of the application**
 - ✓ *Multiplayer games, P2P file sharing, banking, or reaching consensus among parties that are geographically distant*
- **Availability despite unreliable components / Enhanced reliability**
- **Scale up capacity**
 - Processing
 - Storage

Individual computers have limited resources compared to scale of current day problems & application domains

Why distributed systems?



- Resource sharing: peripherals, data sets, libraries
 - Access to geographically remote data and resources
- Conquer geographic separation
 - ✓ *A web request in India is faster served by a server in India than by a server in US.*
- Increased performance/cost ratio
- Modularity and incremental expandability

Question



Q. Which of the following is not true for a Distributed System:

- (a) No global physical clock $\checkmark$
- (b) Communication (mostly) through message passing $\checkmark$
- (c) No resource sharing F
- (d) Concurrent execution $\checkmark$

